

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

Bethel Global Missions
No.18. 27th May 2024



LOOKING FOR THE BEAUTIFUL

OUR FOCUS: SEEING

-THE LOVELY

-THE GOOD

-THE THINGS THAT ARE PRAISEWORTHY

LEARNING / PRACTICING TO SEE.

PRACTICING TO LOOK FOR THE BEAUTIFUL things that are around us – close to us. Practicing means just that practice – repeated action.

NO DELIBERATE IN OUR SEARCHING

Sometimes we are not deliberately seeking to see beauty.

SHORT SIGHTEDNESS

Sometimes we are short sighted – we fail to SEE those things that are near us. AMONG THE THINGS AROUND US

CREATION

This includes the creation – that we view every day.

The trees, the birds, the rivers, the mountains, the flowers etc.

GOD'S SEAL IN CREATION

Romans 1:20 For since the creation of the world God's invisible qualities — his eternal power and divine nature — have been clearly seen, being understood from what has been made, so that men are without excuse. NIV

God has set his seal in creation, and we are instructed not to worship the creation – BUT THE CREATOR.

THE CREATION'S BEAUTY

In creation we can see his power, his wisdom, his uniqueness, his character, his love, his ability to make beautiful diverse things – things that bring pleasure and delight– and even though the creation was placed in bondage because of Man's sin (Adam) **THERE ARE STILL MANY BEAUTIFUL THINGS TO BEHOLD.**

THEIR MESSAGE TO US

Also, there are simple but profound messages that we benefit from by taking time to notice those creatures that God has made.

The diverse kind of trees, rivers, the mountains, the wildflowers, the animal's natural instinct to care for their newborn ones.

What about the singing birds at the break of each new day and their protectiveness of their young at nesting time, etc.?

WHAT MESSAGE DO THEY SEND TO YOU AND ME?

- Are we as **protective of 'our young' (new converts)** as the birds?
- **How do we wake up each morning, singing** (giving thanks - in bird language); OR are we different to that (**complaining, seeing the gloom of our present circumstances**).
- Notice, that the birds don't know where today's meals/food will come but they are **singing because they are at least alive**. I encourage you all to try **giving thanks** each day **that you are alive**; it is better than being dead.
- **King Solomon says, it's better to be a living dog than a dead lion.** Ecclesiastes 9:4-5 Anyone who is among the living has hope—**even a live dog is better off than a dead lion!** - 5 For the living know that they will die, but the dead know nothing; they have no further reward, and even the memory of them is forgotten. NIV

PEOPLE AROUND US?

- But there are also those PEOPLE that are around us, what do we see in them?
- Do we look for the beauty in them or ugliness of their slowness of change or of their past or present failures, their inadequacies?

POSSESSIONS

- Those THINGS that we have/own or use.
- **My testimony:** many a night spent in a village in PNG consisted of only a flat piece of plywood or a house door for my bed, a mosquito net in the open or a house with no walls etc and each night I purposefully gave thanks to God expressing to him appreciation for my palace/cathedral arranged for me tonight by the generosity of the people that provided for me. Sleeping on the ground in the pitch-black jungles of PNG with only a net – it was still the same – giving thanks to God for ‘my house’ for that night and asking to close my ears to strange noises of and the many creepy crawly things of the jungle floor – but always had a good night’s sleep. PTL

BEAUTY IS NOT PERFECTION

- Sometimes **our interpretation of the word beauty** needs to be changed. Too often we think beauty is perfection but that is a very restrictive description **of beauty**.
- There are many things that are not fully formed or matured or completed which **are still beautiful** at that stage of growth or maturity.
- **Beauty** is not only related to the finished or completed product or project – **there is beauty** to be seen all along the period of the journey or the process.
- **Example:** The green grape - the tender grape is beautiful to God - it is not yet ripe and ready to eat - but still beautiful to God.

LOOK AT OUR BEGINNING

To **see beauty** look at the beginning or the origin of something especially people. Where they came from – their progress, growth and change, they may not yet be accomplished, or perfect but nevertheless **beautiful things are in their lives**.

BEYOND THE CLOUDS

- **PRACTICE LOOKING BEYOND THE GLOOMY CLOUDS OF OUR CIRCUMSTANCES AND SEE THE “SUN” SHINING with healing in his wings - – Malachi 4:2 But for you who revere my name, the sun of righteousness will rise with healing in its wings. And you will go out and leap like calves released from the stall. NIV**

PRACTICE FOCUSING ON FINDING;

- **THE GOOD THINGS** THAT ARE HAPPENING AROUND US EVEN IN THE MIDST OF THOSE ADVERSE THINGS THAT YOU ARE PRESENTLY FACING.
- **THERE IS BEAUTY ALL AROUND US, BUT THE KEY IS SEEING IT.**
IF WE DO THEN IT WILL PROMPT US **TO GIVE THANKS FOR IT.**

LEARNING TO DAILY PRACTICE BEING THANKFUL

Colossians 3:15 *Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts, remembering that as members of the same body you are called to live in harmony, **and never forget to be thankful** for what God has done for you. PHILLIPS.*

I WAS DEEPLY IMPACTED with the response of Jesus to the little boys offering of 5 loaves and 2 small fish. JESUS **GAVE THANKS for it** because he could **see the beauty of** the little boy’s willingness to give; and no matter how small the gift was – **Jesus gave thanks for it.**

NOTICE THE CONTRAST BETWEEN JESUS RESPONSE AND THE RESPONSE OF THE DISCIPLES – **Jesus gave thanks John 6:9- BUT the disciples said: but what good are these for so many people?” John 6:11 –**

- **JESUS COULD SEE THE BEAUTY** of the little boys offering **BUT NOT THE DISCIPLES**
- This reminds me of the disciple’s attitude **regarding the woman showering Jesus with precious ointment – The disciples said, “To what purpose is this waste”. They couldn’t see the beauty of her act – BUT JESUS COULD.**
- **Matthew 26:8 But when his disciples saw it, they had indignation, saying, To what purpose is this waste? KJV - Mark 14:4 And there were some that had indignation within themselves, and said, Why was this waste of the ointment made? KJV**
- **JESUS RESPONSE.** Mark 14:6 And Jesus said, Let her alone; why trouble ye her? she hath wrought a good work on me. KJV

Amen – Ps Barry